

09

The Fianchetto Variation

Play against a stable king and a bishop that contests your long diagonal



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

Replace automatic kingside attacking ideas with patient central and queenside pressure.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 049 | PAGE 4

*Against a fianchetto, attack the center before the shelter.***Decode: The symmetrical bishop battle**

LESSON 050 | PAGE 8

*Against a fianchetto, attack the center before the shelter.***Play: The symmetrical bishop battle**

LESSON 051 | PAGE 12

*Release tension only when the open line belongs to you.***Decode: The e-file exchange**

LESSON 052 | PAGE 16

*Release tension only when the open line belongs to you.***Play: The e-file exchange**

LESSON 053 | PAGE 20

*Ask which bishop benefits before opening a diagonal.***Decode: The closed fianchetto center**

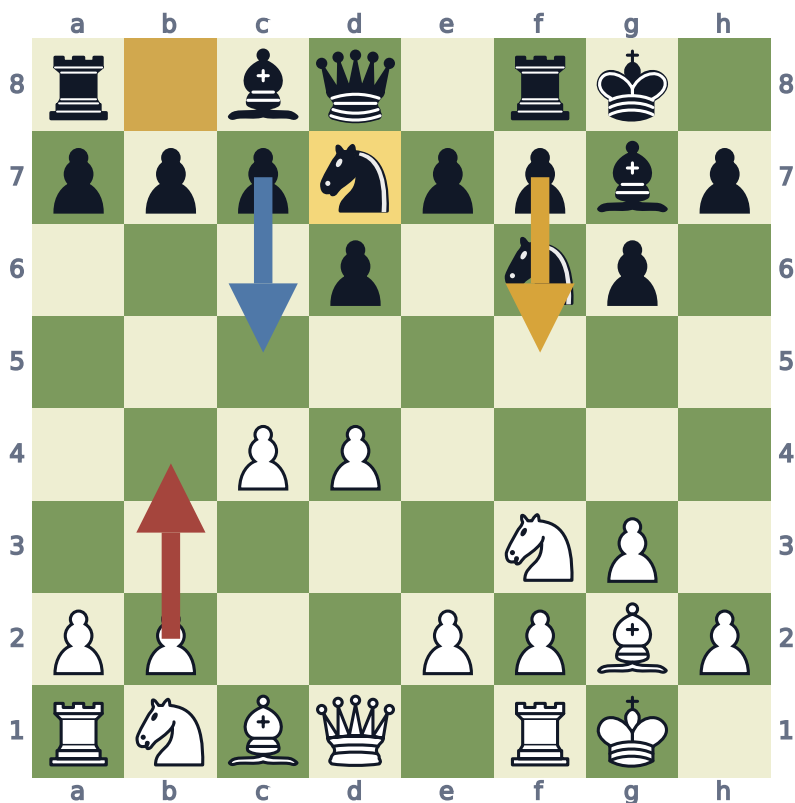
LESSON 054 | PAGE 24

*Ask which bishop benefits before opening a diagonal.***Play: The closed fianchetto center****VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

Replace automatic kingside attacking ideas with patient central and queenside pressure.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The symmetrical bishop battle



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Both kings are safe and both bishops influence the long diagonal, so central structure and breaks matter more than a direct pawn storm.

DECISION RULE

Decide whether closing with ...e5 is active or whether ...c5 gives better pressure.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Prepare ...c6, ...exd4, or ...Re8 and seek useful queenside expansion.

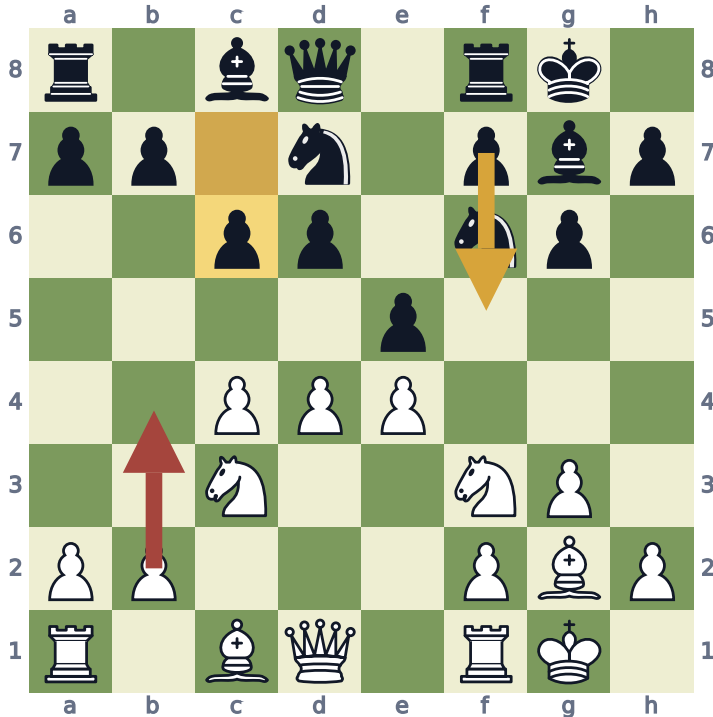
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants d5, h3, Be3, and control of the center without weakening the king.

MEMORY RULE | Against a fianchetto, attack the center before the shelter.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Both kings are safe and both bishops influence the long diagonal, so central structure and breaks matter more than a direct pawn storm.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Prepare ...c6, ...exd4, or ...Re8 and seek useful queenside expansion.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White wants d5, h3, Be3, and control of the center without weakening the king.

FAILURE MODE

Copying Mar del Plata kingside play ignores White's fianchetto defense.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Decide whether closing with ...e5 is active or whether ...c5 gives better pressure. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

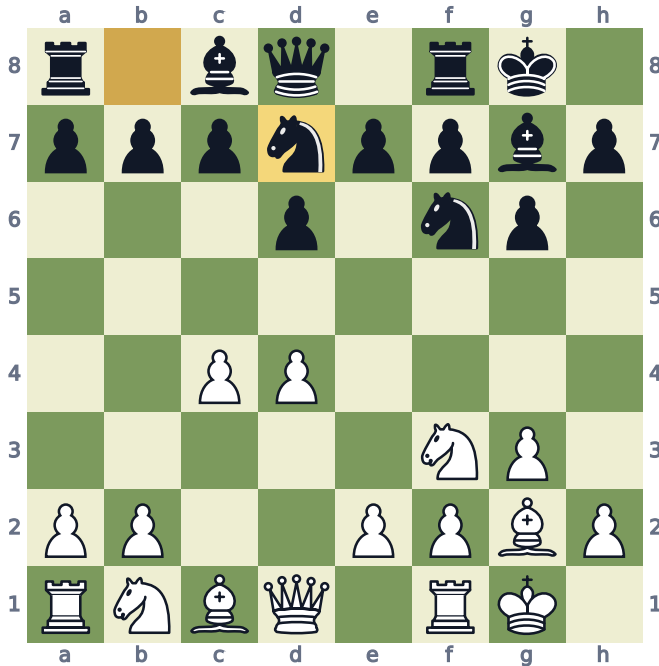
RULE | Against a fianchetto, attack the center before the shelter.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. e4 c6



- g3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight toward d7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Both kings are safe and both bishops influence the long diagonal, so central structure and breaks matter more than a direct pawn storm.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Decide whether closing with ...e5 is active or whether ...c5 gives better pressure. White's resistance is: White wants d5, h3, Be3, and control of the center without weakening the king. The line fails as a template when: Copying Mar del Plata kingside play ignores White's fianchetto defense.

STORE THIS | Against a fianchetto, attack the center before the shelter.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

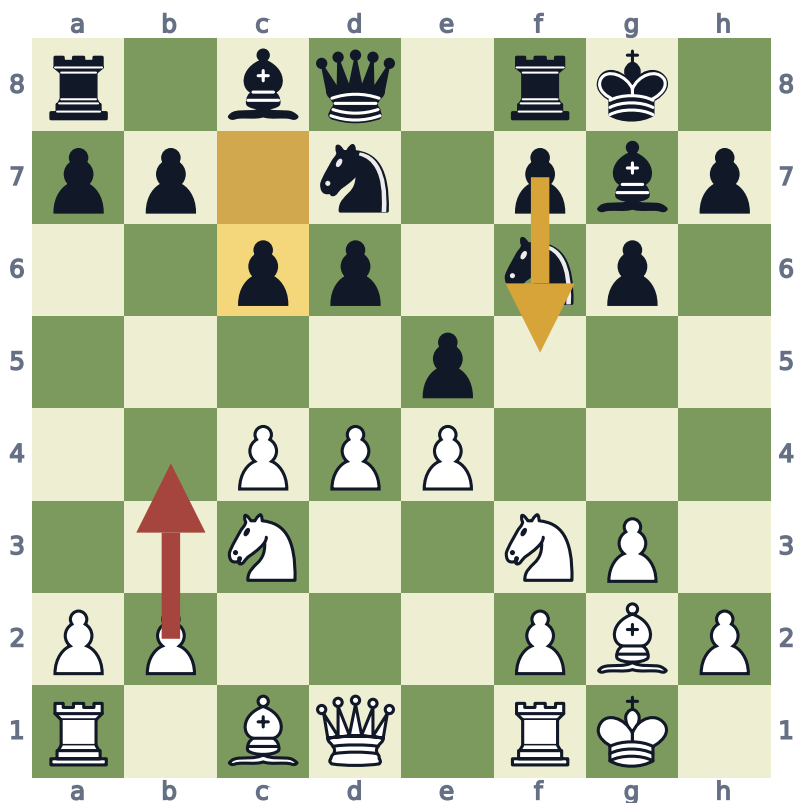
1. Both kings are safe and both bishops influence the long diagonal, so central structure and breaks matter more than a direct pawn storm. 2. Prepare ...c6, ...exd4, or ...Re8 and seek useful queenside expansion. 3. White wants d5, h3, Be3, and control of the center without weakening the king. 4. Decide whether closing with ...e5 is active or whether ...c5 gives better pressure. 5. Copying Mar del Plata kingside play ignores White's fianchetto defense.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The symmetrical bishop battle



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Both kings are safe and both bishops influence the long diagonal, so central structure and breaks matter more than a direct pawn storm.

DECISION RULE

Decide whether closing with ...e5 is active or whether ...c5 gives better pressure.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Prepare ...c6, ...exd4, or ...Re8 and seek useful queenside expansion.

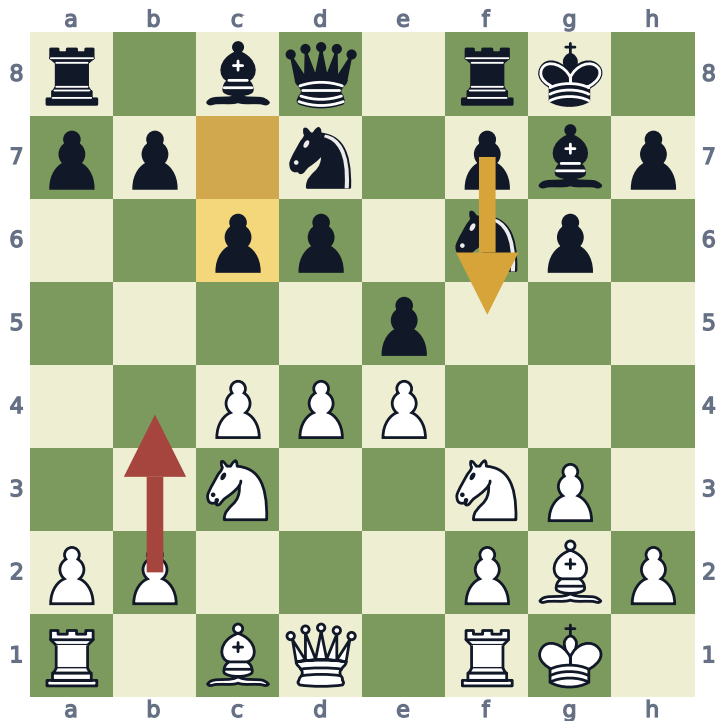
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants d5, h3, Be3, and control of the center without weakening the king.

MEMORY RULE | Against a fianchetto, attack the center before the shelter.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Both kings are safe and both bishops influence the long diagonal, so central structure and breaks matter more than a direct pawn storm.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Prepare ...c6, ...exd4, or ...Re8 and seek useful queenside expansion.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White wants d5, h3, Be3, and control of the center without weakening the king.

FAILURE MODE

Copying Mar del Plata kingside play ignores White's fianchetto defense.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Decide whether closing with ...e5 is active or whether ...c5 gives better pressure. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

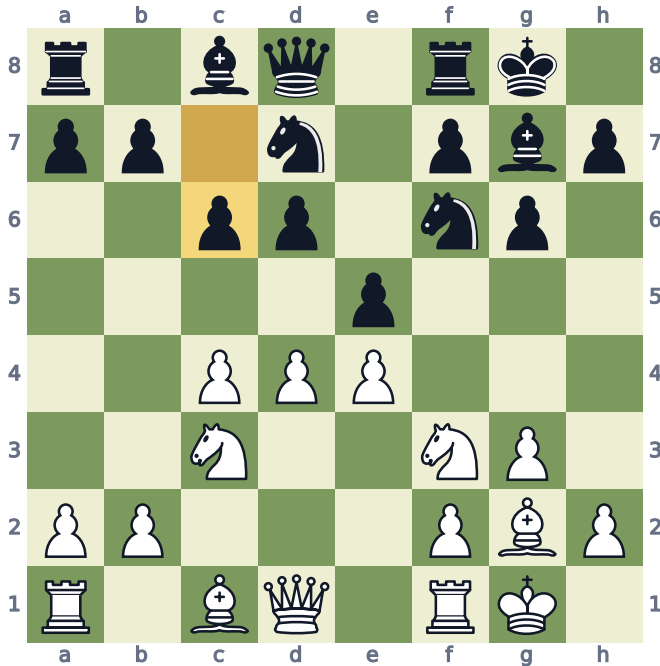
RULE | Against a fianchetto, attack the center before the shelter.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. e4 c6



- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight toward d7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight toward c3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- e5: Black makes direct central contact and asks whether White will close, capture, or maintain tension.
- e4: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- c6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Both kings are safe and both bishops influence the long diagonal, so central structure and breaks matter more than a direct pawn storm.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Decide whether closing with ...e5 is active or whether ...c5 gives better pressure. White's resistance is: White wants d5, h3, Be3, and control of the center without weakening the king. The line fails as a template when: Copying Mar del Plata kingside play ignores White's fianchetto defense.

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1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

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4. What exact question decides the next move?

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ANSWER KEY

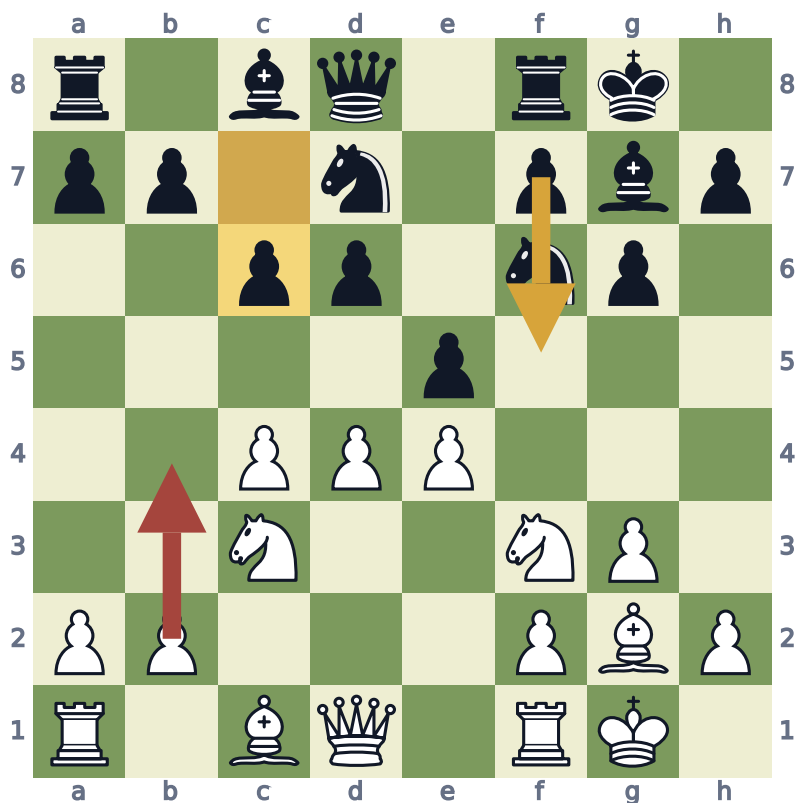
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. e4 c6

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The e-file exchange

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

Exchanging on d4 can expose e4 and create active e-file pressure without conceding the long diagonal.

DECISION RULE

Choose ...exd4 only when the opened file and piece activity compensate for releasing tension.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use rooks and knights against e4 while stopping White's queenside expansion.

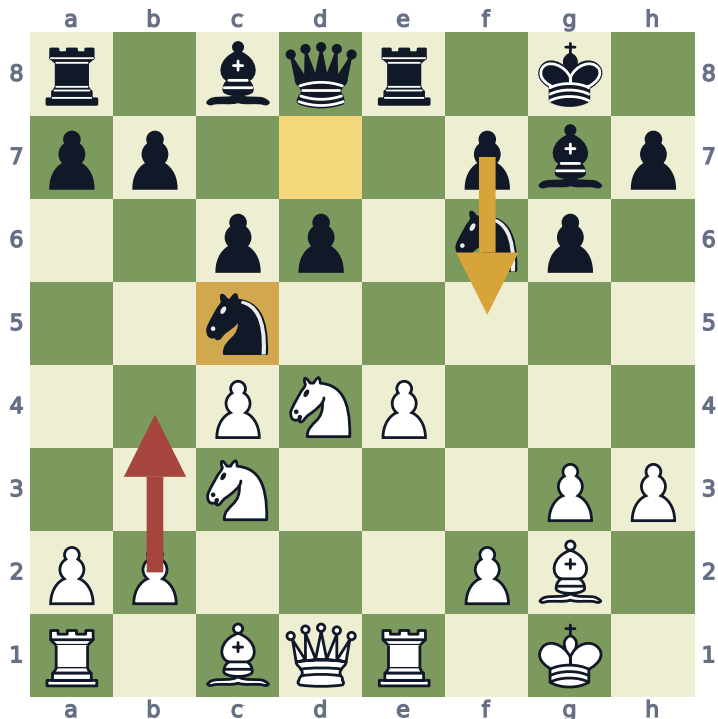
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White centralizes the knight and may use Be3, Qd2, or b4.

MEMORY RULE | Release tension only when the open line belongs to you.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Exchanging on d4 can expose e4 and create active e-file pressure without conceding the long diagonal.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use rooks and knights against e4 while stopping White's queenside expansion.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White centralizes the knight and may use Be3, Qd2, or b4.

FAILURE MODE

Clarifying the center can solve White's space problem for free.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Choose ...exd4 only when the opened file and piece activity compensate for releasing tension. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

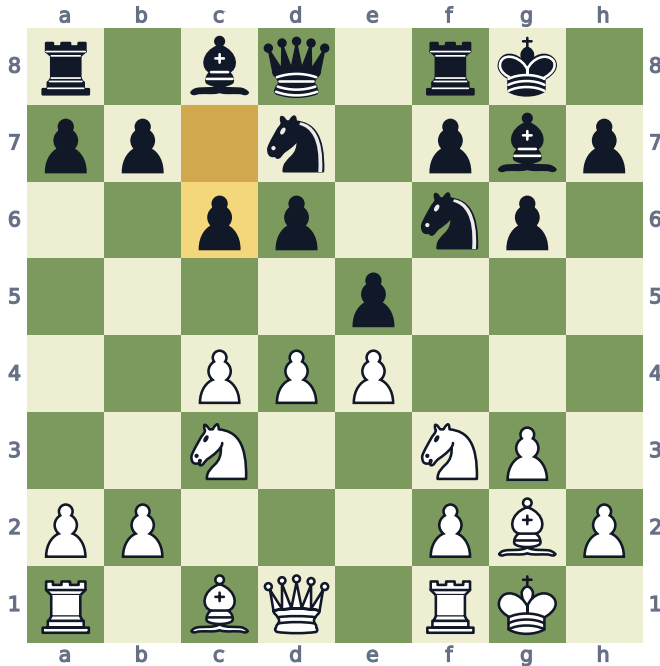
RULE | Release tension only when the open line belongs to you.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight toward d7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight toward c3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- e5: Black makes direct central contact and asks whether White will close, capture, or maintain tension.
- e4: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- c6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

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WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Choose ...exd4 only when the opened file and piece activity compensate for releasing tension. White's resistance is: White centralizes the knight and may use Be3, Qd2, or b4. The line fails as a template when: Clarifying the center can solve White's space problem for free.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

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1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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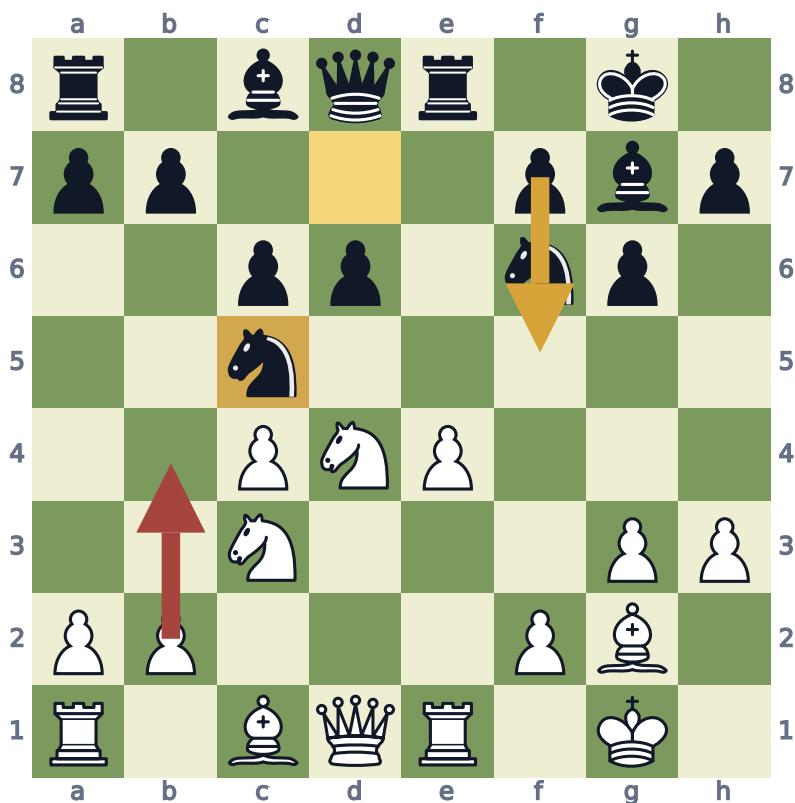
1. Exchanging on d4 can expose e4 and create active e-file pressure without conceding the long diagonal. 2. Use rooks and knights against e4 while stopping White's queenside expansion. 3. White centralizes the knight and may use Be3, Qd2, or b4. 4. Choose ...exd4 only when the opened file and piece activity compensate for releasing tension. 5. Clarifying the center can solve White's space problem for free.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. e4 c6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The e-file exchange



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Exchanging on d4 can expose e4 and create active e-file pressure without conceding the long diagonal.

DECISION RULE

Choose ...exd4 only when the opened file and piece activity compensate for releasing tension.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use rooks and knights against e4 while stopping White's queenside expansion.

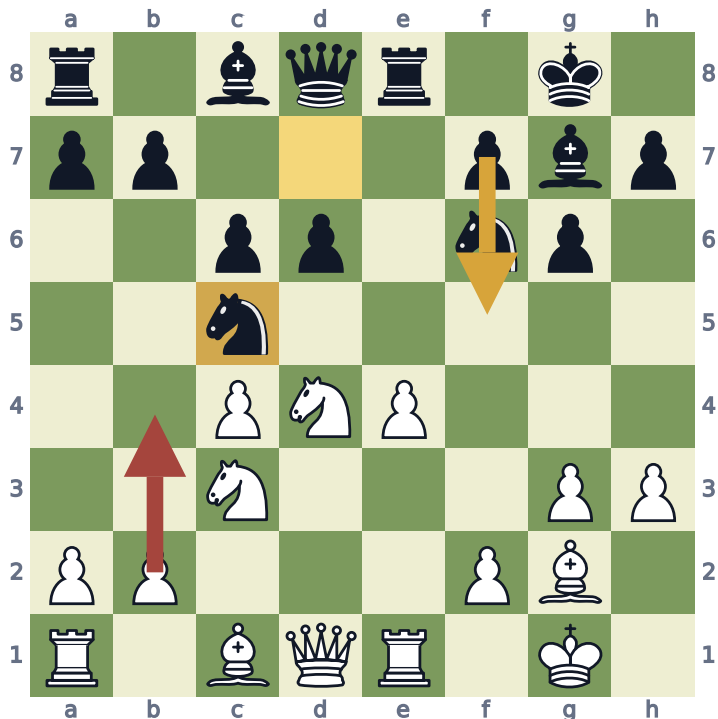
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White centralizes the knight and may use Be3, Qd2, or b4.

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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Exchanging on d4 can expose e4 and create active e-file pressure without conceding the long diagonal.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use rooks and knights against e4 while stopping White's queenside expansion.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White centralizes the knight and may use Be3, Qd2, or b4.

FAILURE MODE

Clarifying the center can solve White's space problem for free.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Choose ...exd4 only when the opened file and piece activity compensate for releasing tension. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

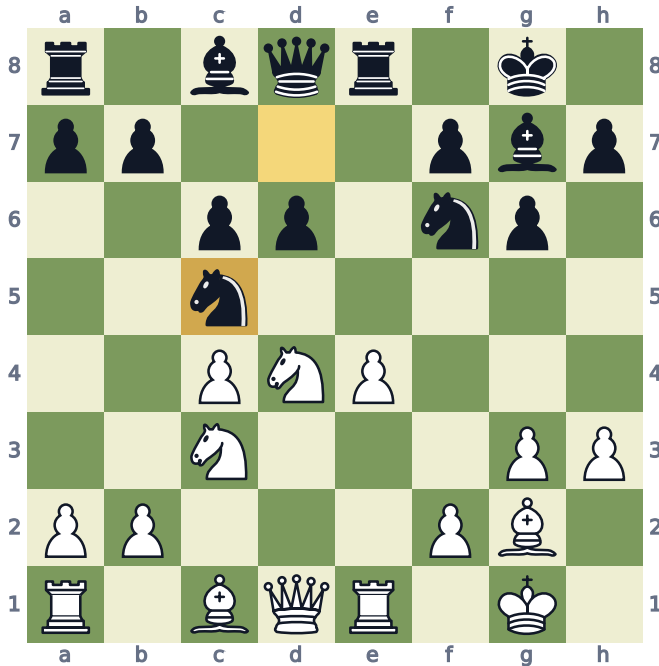
RULE | Release tension only when the open line belongs to you.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- h3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- exd4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- Nxd4: White reroutes a knight toward d4; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Re8: Black places a rook on a line expected to open or uses it to support a central transformation.
- Re1: White places a rook on a line expected to open or uses it to support a central transformation.
- Nc5: Black reroutes a knight toward c5; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Exchanging on d4 can expose e4 and create active e-file pressure without conceding the long diagonal.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Choose ...exd4 only when the opened file and piece activity compensate for releasing tension. White's resistance is: White centralizes the knight and may use Be3, Qd2, or b4. The line fails as a template when: Clarifying the center can solve White's space problem for free.

STORE THIS | Release tension only when the open line belongs to you.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

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ANSWER KEY

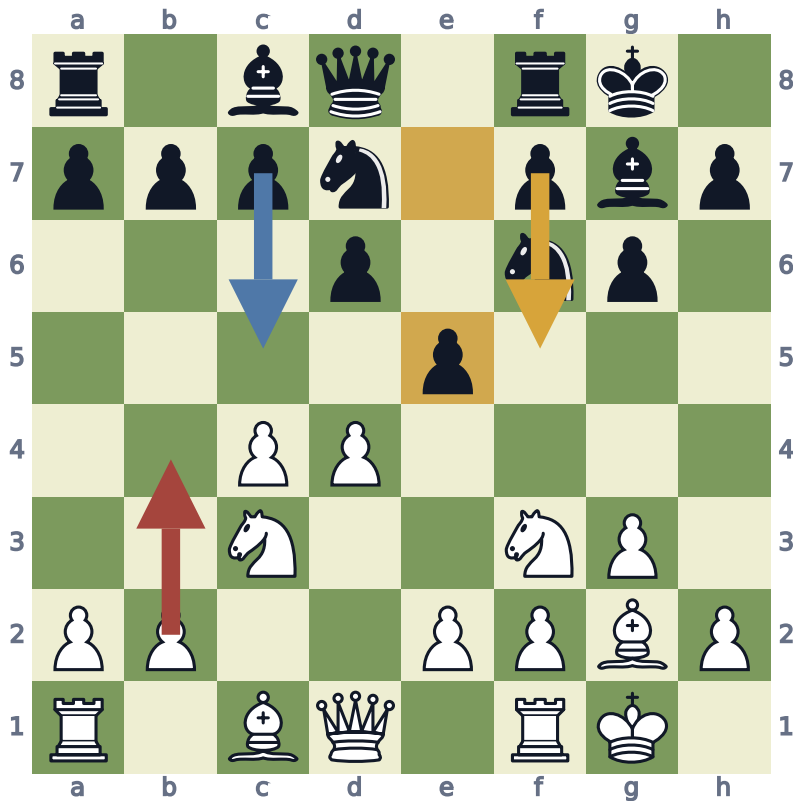
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 22 plies from memory, then replay: 9. h3 exd4 10. Nxd4 Re8 11. Re1 Nc5

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The closed fianchetto center

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

White closes the center and builds e4, producing a slower battle with queenside and central maneuvering.

DECISION RULE

Check whether ...f5 opens the g2-bishop toward b7 or creates real kingside access.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Restrain b4 with ...a5, use c5 or e7 routes, and search for ...f5 only when supported.

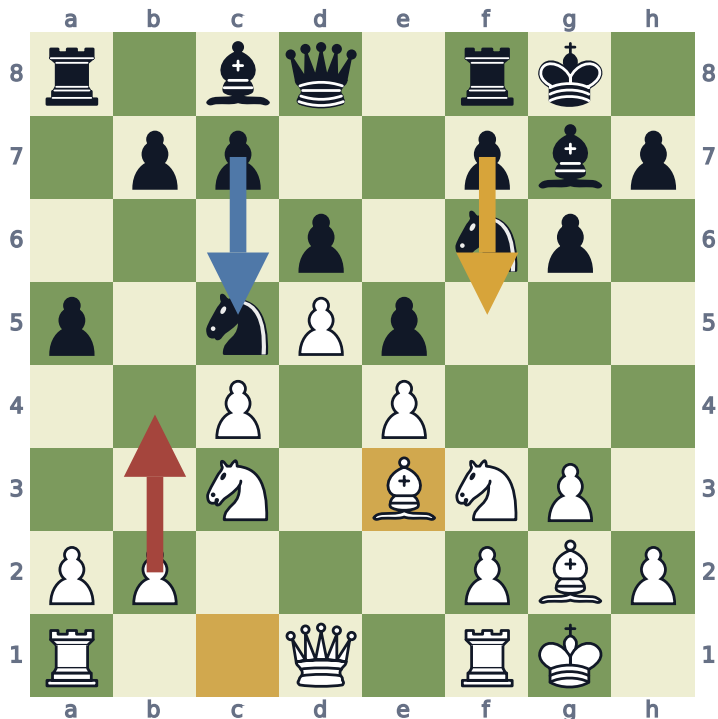
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White prepares Ne1-d3, b3, or queenside space while the g2-bishop remains influential.

MEMORY RULE | Ask which bishop benefits before opening a diagonal.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White closes the center and builds e4, producing a slower battle with queenside and central maneuvering.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Restrain b4 with ...a5, use c5 or e7 routes, and search for ...f5 only when supported.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White prepares Ne1-d3, b3, or queenside space while the g2-bishop remains influential.

FAILURE MODE

A thematic break can improve the opponent's best piece.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Check whether ...f5 opens the g2-bishop toward b7 or creates real kingside access. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

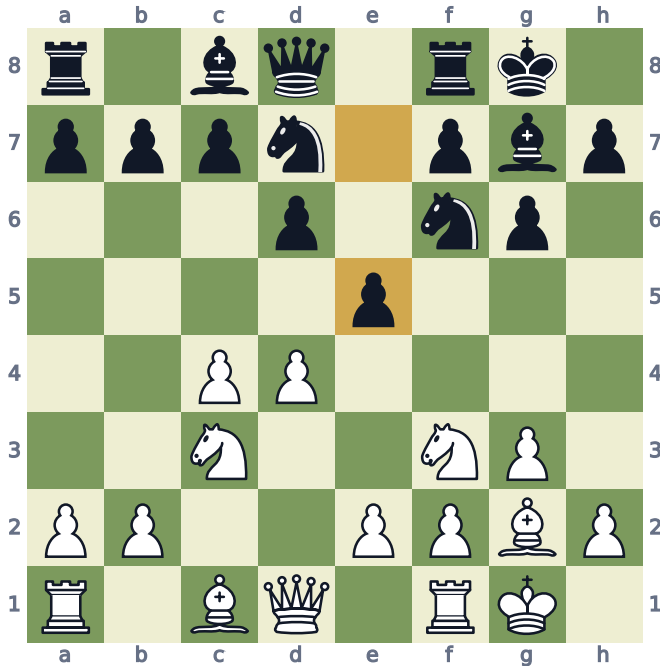
RULE | Ask which bishop benefits before opening a diagonal.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. d5 a5 9. e4 Nc5 10. Be3



- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight toward d7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight toward c3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- e5: Black makes direct central contact and asks whether White will close, capture, or maintain tension.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

White closes the center and builds e4, producing a slower battle with queenside and central maneuvering.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Check whether ...f5 opens the g2-bishop toward b7 or creates real kingside access. White's resistance is: White prepares Ne1-d3, b3, or queenside space while the g2-bishop remains influential. The line fails as a template when: A thematic break can improve the opponent's best piece.

STORE THIS | Ask which bishop benefits before opening a diagonal.

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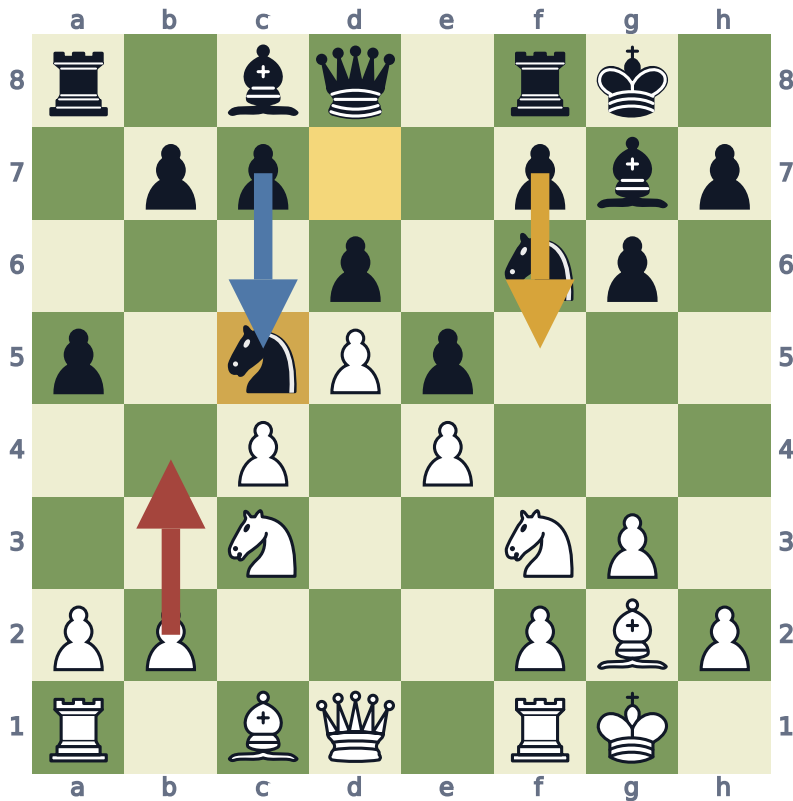
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The closed fianchetto center



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

White closes the center and builds e4, producing a slower battle with queenside and central maneuvering.

DECISION RULE

Check whether ...f5 opens the g2-bishop toward b7 or creates real kingside access.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

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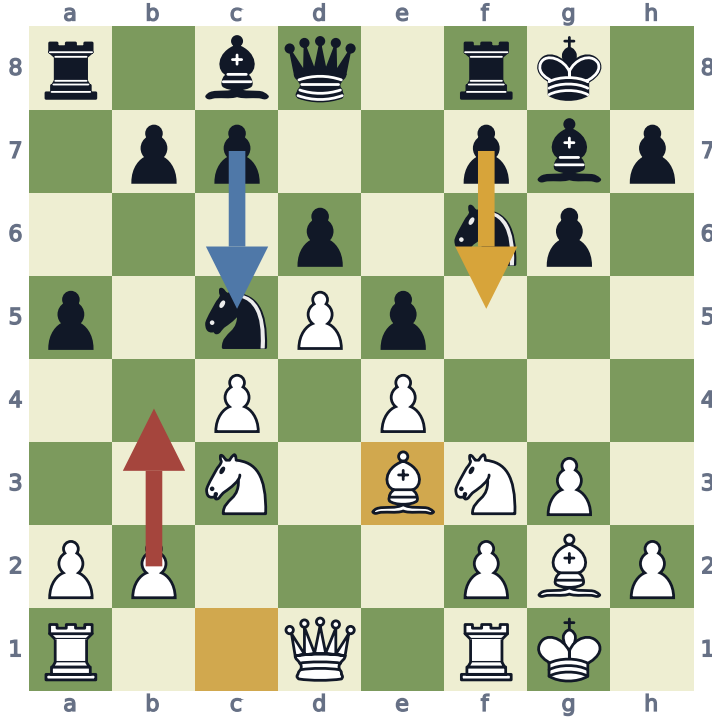
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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

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BLACK AIMS FOR

Restrain b4 with ...a5, use c5 or e7 routes, and search for ...f5 only when supported.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White prepares Ne1-d3, b3, or queenside space while the g2-bishop remains influential.

FAILURE MODE

A thematic break can improve the opponent's best piece.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Check whether ...f5 opens the g2-bishop toward b7 or creates real kingside access. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

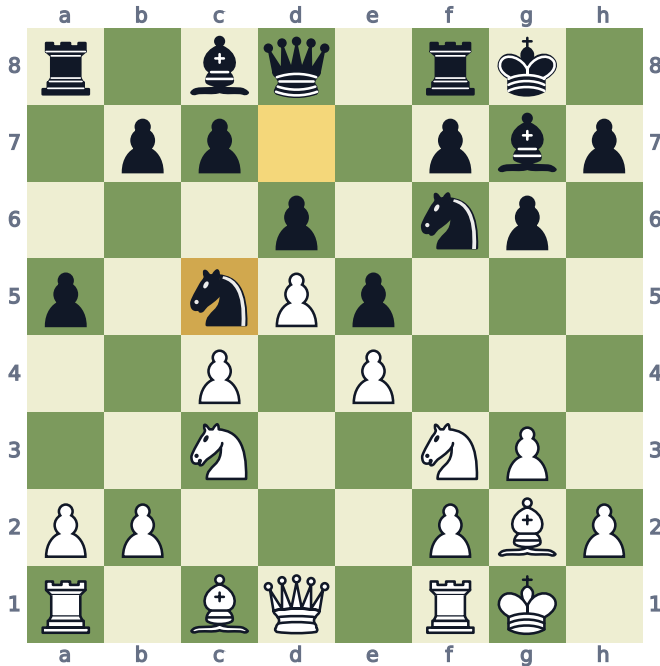
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- Nc3: White reroutes a knight toward c3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- e5: Black makes direct central contact and asks whether White will close, capture, or maintain tension.
- d5: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- e4: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- Nc5: Black reroutes a knight toward c5; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

White closes the center and builds e4, producing a slower battle with queenside and central maneuvering.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Check whether ...f5 opens the g2-bishop toward b7 or creates real kingside access. White's resistance is: White prepares Ne1-d3, b3, or queenside space while the g2-bishop remains influential. The line fails as a template when: A thematic break can improve the opponent's best piece.

STORE THIS | Ask which bishop benefits before opening a diagonal.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. White closes the center and builds e4, producing a slower battle with queenside and central maneuvering. 2. Restrain b4 with ...a5, use c5 or e7 routes, and search for ...f5 only when supported. 3. White prepares Ne1-d3, b3, or queenside space while the g2-bishop remains influential. 4. Check whether ...f5 opens the g2-bishop toward b7 or creates real kingside access. 5. A thematic break can improve the opponent's best piece.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. Nc3 e5 8. d5 a5 9. e4 Nc5

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 049 Decode: The symmetrical bishop battle

Prompt: Decide whether closing with ...e5 is active or whether ...c5 gives better pressure.

Recall: Against a fianchetto, attack the center before the shelter.

LESSON 050 Play: The symmetrical bishop battle

Prompt: Decide whether closing with ...e5 is active or whether ...c5 gives better pressure.

Recall: Against a fianchetto, attack the center before the shelter.

LESSON 051 Decode: The e-file exchange

Prompt: Choose ...exd4 only when the opened file and piece activity compensate for releasing tension.

Recall: Release tension only when the open line belongs to you.

LESSON 052 Play: The e-file exchange

Prompt: Choose ...exd4 only when the opened file and piece activity compensate for releasing tension.

Recall: Release tension only when the open line belongs to you.

LESSON 053 Decode: The closed fianchetto center

Prompt: Check whether ...f5 opens the g2-bishop toward b7 or creates real kingside access.

Recall: Ask which bishop benefits before opening a diagonal.

LESSON 054 Play: The closed fianchetto center

Prompt: Check whether ...f5 opens the g2-bishop toward b7 or creates real kingside access.

Recall: Ask which bishop benefits before opening a diagonal.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The symmetrical bishop battle

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. e4 c6

Decision: Decide whether closing with ...e5 is active or whether ...c5 gives better pressure.

Memory: Against a fianchetto, attack the center before the shelter.

CARD 2

The e-file exchange

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. e4 c6 9. h3 exd4 10. Nxd4 Re8 11. Re1 Nc5

Decision: Choose ...exd4 only when the opened file and piece activity compensate for releasing tension.

Memory: Release tension only when the open line belongs to you.

CARD 3

The closed fianchetto center

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. d5 a5 9. e4 Nc5 10. Be3

Decision: Check whether ...f5 opens the g2-bishop toward b7 or creates real kingside access.

Memory: Ask which bishop benefits before opening a diagonal.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
049 Decode: The symmetrical bishop battle	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
050 Play: The symmetrical bishop battle	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
051 Decode: The e-file exchange	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
052 Play: The e-file exchange	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
053 Decode: The closed fianchetto center	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
054 Play: The closed fianchetto center	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.